

1947, February 21

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

SAINT FELIX CAPUCHIN FRIARY

HUNTINGTON INDIANA.

February 21st 1947.

M. Marie Baxter.
3793 Virginia Park
Detroit, Michigan.

My Dear Mrs. Baxter:

God bless you and yours. Many thanks for your appreciated favor just received and noted. I am taking this before several letters ahead of it. ... I have a brother Patrick Casey of Seattle, Washington. He has been dear to me, having grown up with me since 1871. Ten days ago he was reported as dangerously ill.

He has been a successful business-man and a daily communicant, Thanks be to God for both. I would not want to tell him of a namesake of his having no faith. He would conclude at once: "The boy does not know how to think, and unless he pray for an increase of faith he most likely will lose the little he has and in the end drift to atheism -- "The climax of intellectual and spiritual insanity; because atheism is primarily a suggestion of the devel and the hopeless conclusion at one and the 'desperate refuge of shallow thinking, of degenerate minds and -- fearful to say it, -- of damned fools: - no one the primary leader other than Lucifer himself, the prince of diabolical darkness."

Its a strong definition and to choose to be satisfied with tending to follow such a monster rather than foster faith, hope and charity by which alone, progress can be made in the greatest scienc of all times and of all generations -- RELIGION, "THE SCIENCE OF OUR HAPPY RELATIONSHIP WITH GOD AND OUR NEIGHBOR", must be the choice of ? to say the least, of an unfortunate creature, - supposed to be rational. You can tell that poor P. C. from me as well as from his older namesake that while we sympathze with honest men who tend to think (?) in that line, or are content with the prospects of an eternal blank of even nothing-ness, - to say nothing of hell, in which the vast majority of every age of thinkers have believed - we would at the same time call attention to/obligation we are all under of asking for faith, a free gift of God and without which, God himself has revealed we cannot please Him.